

HUM 2101: Sociology and Disaster Management

Introduction to Basic Concept of Government and Politics

Week 1



Modern State

- A "modern state" is a state in which power and authority are centralized and exercised by an independent administration organization over a clearly defined territory.



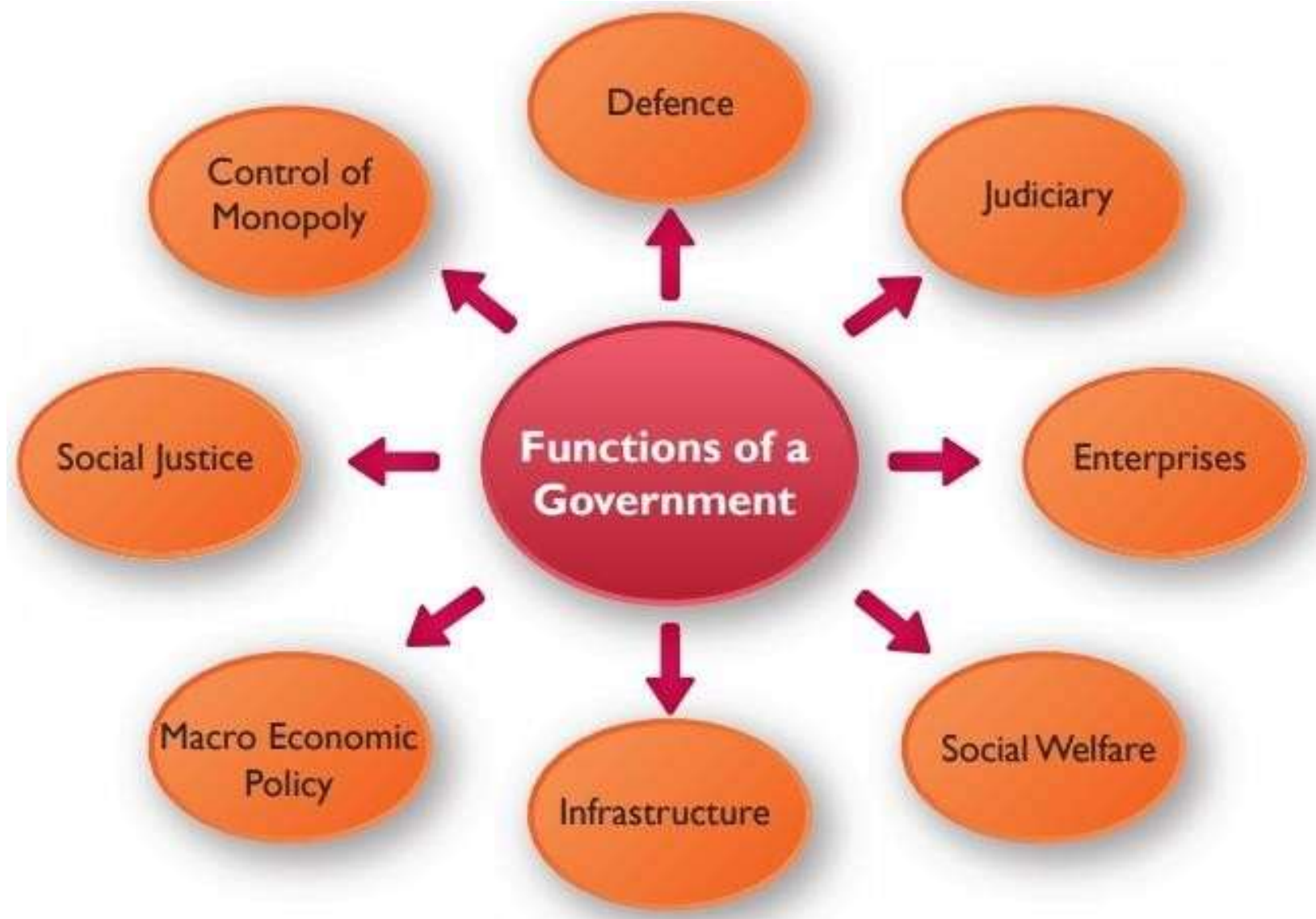
Max Weber

Functions of modern state

- ✓ State should strive to keep its people secure and safe
- ✓ State should ensure that its borders are sealed and protected
- ✓ To make the market work well within society, we need a strong and well-planned economic system.
- ✓ 'Citizen first' should be the motto of all the activities of the State
- ✓ Promotion of the welfare of its people
- ✓ State engages itself as a provider of essential services.

Modern state focuses on three main functions:

1. Security and defence
2. Economic
3. Provision of essential services



Government

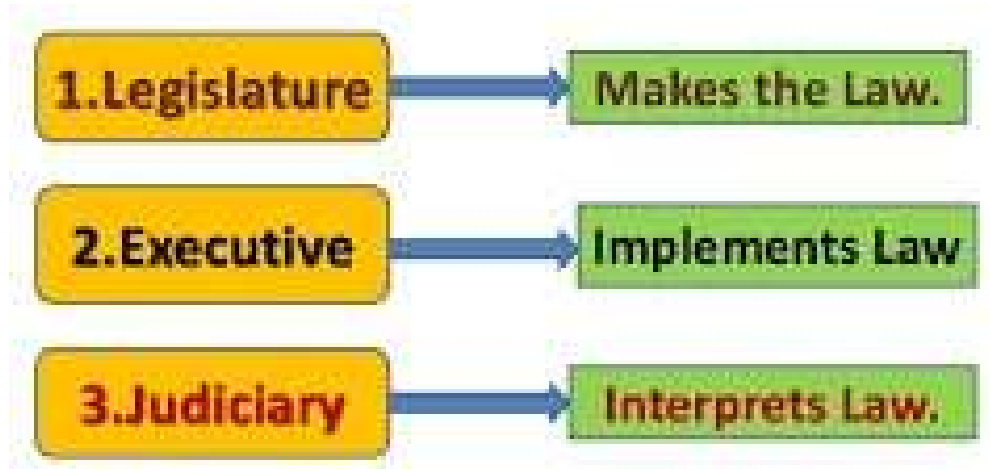
- Government is the system or group of people that governs an organized community, managing laws, resources, and order. It can take various forms, such as democracies or monarchies, and operates through distinct branches.
- Government power can be derived from various sources, including from the people or from the wealthy and powerful.
- Governments are usually divided into various ministries or departments that manage the many tasks that governments are expected to perform today.



Organs of government

- The three organs of the government are:

1. Legislature
2. Judiciary
3. Executive



- In order for a democracy to function effectively, all of its organs must effectively create and carry out laws.
- Laws are created by the legislature, are carried out by the executive, and are then applied by the judiciary in specific cases where a law has been broken.
- Democracy is stable and unified when each of its organs is working in harmony with the others.



3 BRANCHES of GOVERNMENT



Legislative (makes laws)



Congress



Senate

100 elected senators total;
2 senators per state



**House of
Representatives**

435 elected representatives
total; representatives based
on each state's population



Executive (carries out laws)



President



**Vice
President**



Cabinet

Nominated by the
president and must be
approved by the Senate
(with at least 51 votes)



Judicial (evaluates laws)



**Supreme
Court**

9 justices nominated by
the president and must be
approved by the Senate
(with at least 51 votes)



**Other
Federal Courts**



Constitution

(provides a separation of powers)

Organs of the Government and their Functions

Legislature

- The primary duty of the Legislature is **to create the rules and regulations** that all citizens must abide by.
- It also passes laws and examines the administration and resolutions further.
- Legislature is regarded as the first of the three organs because, without it, laws cannot be executed or applied.



Executive

- The second organ Executive, which comprises the,
 - Prime Minister,
 - President/ Governor,
 - Chief Ministers, and
 - Council of Ministers at the Union/State level
- The Executive helps implement the laws formed by the legislature and enforces the will of the government.
- Executive is the administrative head of the state.



Judiciary

- The community courts are at the bottom of the Judiciary, with the Supreme Court of at the top.
- The Judiciary also consists of the high courts, district courts, and lower courts.
- To ensure that the populace receives justice.
- The judiciary is frequently referred to as the "**guardian of the constitution**" or the "**watchdog of democracy**."



BANGLADESH JUDICIARY

Supreme Court

Appellate Division Hon. Chief Justice & 7 Judges

High Court Division 82 Judges

Civil Courts in District Level

Criminal Courts in Metropolitan Area & District Level

Special Courts & Tribunals

District Judge

Session Judge

Metropolitan Session Judge

Addl. District Judges

Chief Judicial Magistrate

Addl. Session Judges

Addl. Metropolitan Session Judges

Chief Metropolitan Magistrate

Jt. District Judges

Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate

Jt. Session Judges

Jt. Metropolitan Session Judges

Addl. Chief Metropolitan Magistrate

Sr. Assistant Judges

Sr. Judicial Magistrates (1st Class)

Metropolitan Magistrates (1st Class)

Assistant Judges

Judicial Magistrates (2nd/3rd Class)

Forms of government



DEMOCRACY



COMMUNISM



SOCIALISM



OLIGARCHY



ARISTOCRACY



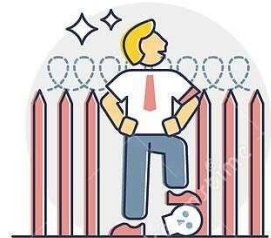
MONARCHY



THEOCRACY



COLONIALISM



TOTALITARIANISM



**MILITARY
DICTATORSHIP**

Democracy

Come from the two Greek words: demos= people, and kratos= power

“Power of the people”/ “Rule by the people”

- ✓ Democracy is a system of government of a country whose leaders have been elected by the people; therefore the power is with the people.
- ✓ This happens through the process of free and fair elections so the people can give their opinions about issues occurring in their communities.



Monarchy

রাজতন্ত্র

A form of government led by an individual who holds the position for life, having inherited the position, and who passes it on to a relative, which is usually a son or daughter.

☐ Absolute monarchy

- ✓ In the past, all monarchs held great power and made all the decisions and laws of the country.
- ✓ Today, most monarchs act as head of state, filling a ceremonial role with little or no power regarding the actual governing of the country.



Constitutional monarchy

- ✓ A country which has a written constitution that sets out the rules for how the country will be governed and the rights and responsibilities of its people and has a monarch as head of the state.

Republic

- ✓ Country where the head of government is an elected or chosen president
- ✓ Sometimes the president is also the head of state
- ✓ Presidents are usually elected for a specific length of time, called a “term of office”.
- ✓ In some countries, a president may only serve for a few terms
- ✓ A republic may or may not be democratic.

Republic - form of government in which power is explicitly vested in the people, who in turn exercise their power through elected representatives.

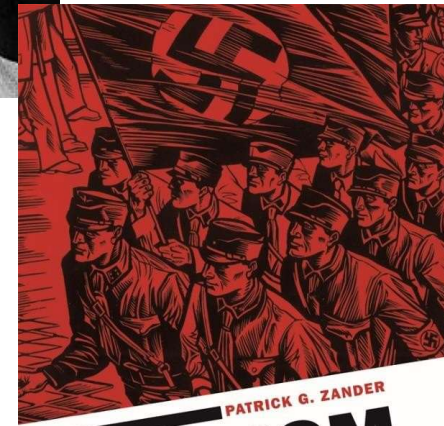


- ✓ In a democratic republic, the people choose their leaders elections, although in countries where a president is in ceremonial role, it may be by government appointment rather than by election.
- ✓ There may be elections, but these may be conducted in corrupt ways, or electors are not given a free choice of who to vote for.

Totalitarianism

সর্বগ্রাসীবাদ

- ✓ In a totalitarian society, the government holds absolute control over all areas of the life of its people.
- ✓ A set of beliefs is imposed on its people, who must conform or face unpleasant consequences.



Fascism

ফ্যাসিবাদ

- ✓ A form of government usually headed by a dictator
- ✓ Involves total government control of political, economic, cultural, religious, and social activities.

Dictatorship

- ✓ Open person, called a Dictator, has absolute power
- ✓ This differs from totalitarianism in that it is less controlling and not marked by a rigid set of beliefs
- ✓ Sometimes a country run by a dictatorship maybe called a republic. Such republics have only one political party and the dictator makes most government policies and decisions.

Communism(সামম্বাদ)

- ✓ An economic system in which there is little or no private ownership of anything
- ✓ Property is held by the community rather than by individuals
- ✓ All economic activity is controlled by the government, including what food crops are grown, what goods are manufactured, and to whom they are sold and at what prices
- ✓ Limited personal freedom of individuals is allowed, travel and how they spend their



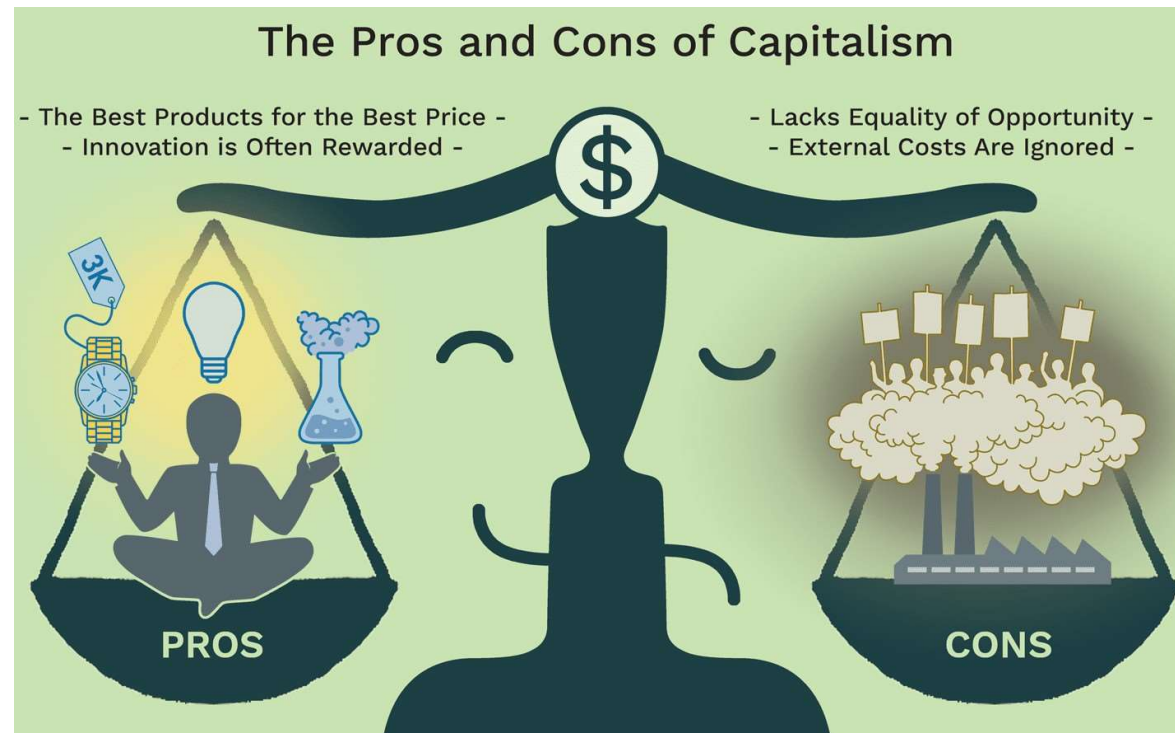
Socialism(সমাজতন্ত্)

- ✓ Socialism is a system where the government or community owns resources and businesses. It aims to ensure everyone has equal access to basic needs like healthcare and education, reducing inequality. In socialism, the focus is on reducing inequality and providing support for all people, rather than allowing a few to become very rich while others struggle.



Capitalism (পুঁজিবাদ)

- Capitalism is an economic system in which private individuals or businesses own capital goods.
- Capitalism is often thought of as an economic system in which private actors own and control property in accord with their interests, and demand and supply freely set prices in markets in a way that can serve the best interests of society.
- The essential feature of capitalism is the motive to make a profit.



Citizenship

- Citizenship is the expression of a public identity.
- It is the recognition of an official position by a government and the ability to enjoy the rights and privileges following from that position by an individual.
- Citizenship is also the subjective belonging to the public identity of a country.
- It involves claiming, exercising, and contesting rights, entitlements, and obligations.



Feudalism

- Derived from the Latin word:
Feodum or Feudum (fief) [used during the
Medieval period]
- Feudalism is a form of socio-economic
and political organization with three
distinct social classes:
 1. King or queen
 2. Nobles, which includes princes and
priests
 3. Peasants

In a feudal society, status is based on land ownership

- ✓ The **King** owned all the available land, and he portioned out that to his nobles for their use
- ✓ The **Nobles** rented out their land to peasants
- ✓ The **Peasants** paid the nobles in produce and military service; the nobles, in turn paid the king



Political importance of feudalism

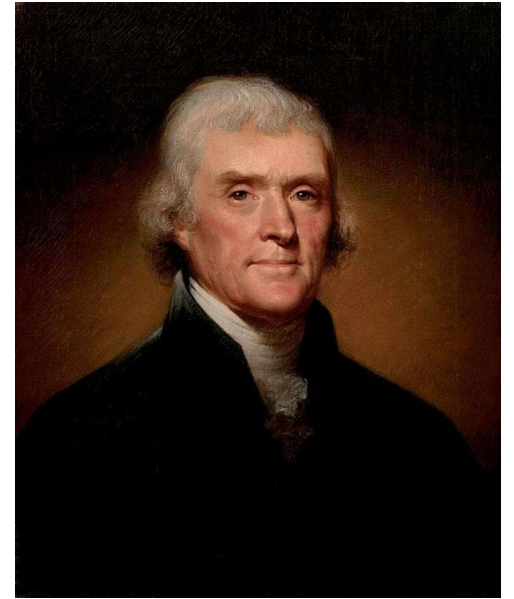
- It was conceived of as a formal political system by the people who lived during the Middle Ages

English feudalism

- English feudalism is thought to have arisen in the 11th century CE under the William the Conqueror.
- When he had the common law altered after the Norman Conquest in 1066.
- William took possession of all of England.
- Then parceled it out among his leading supporters as tenancies, or fiefs, to be held in return for services to the king



- Feudalism famously developed in Europe during the Middle Ages
- It has been identified in many other societies and time including the imperial governments of Rome, Japan, and the United States of America.
- American founding Father Thomas Jefferson
- It was convinced that the new United States was practicing a form of feudalism in the 18th Century



Feudalism arises in places where there is **an absence of organized government** and the **presence of violence**.

- A contractual relationship is formed between ruler and ruled:
 - ✓ Ruler provides access to the required land
 - ✓ The rest of the people provide support to the ruler

In England

- ✓ Feudalism was formalized into a legal system
- ✓ It was written into the laws of the country and codifying a tripartite relationship between political allegiance, military service, and property ownership

